

Andolo Gideon Youths (AGY)

Funding Proposal: The Langatta Sound Foundry

1. Executive Summary

The Langatta Sound Foundry (LSF) is a proposed state-of-the-art music production studio and youth development centre located in the heart of Langatta, Nairobi. This initiative seeks to address a critical gap in resources for creative youth by transforming untapped musical talent into professional skill sets, fostering economic opportunity, and promoting positive community engagement.

Langatta is home to a vibrant, youthful population rich in cultural expression but lacking access to professional equipment, mentorship, and safe creative spaces. The LSF will bridge this gap by providing a fully equipped recording and production studio, structured mentorship from industry professionals, and comprehensive training in music business and technology.

This proposal seeks **KES 19,500,000** in seed funding to cover startup costs, equipment, facility renovation, and initial operational expenses. Over a three-year period, the project aims to directly serve 150 young individuals through intensive programmes, reach over 500 through workshops, and produce a portfolio of original works that showcase the talent of Langatta to the wider world.

2. Project Description

Mission and Vision

- **Mission:** To empower the youth of Langatta by providing access to professional music production tools, world-class mentorship, and entrepreneurial training, transforming their passion into a pathway for personal and professional success.
- **Vision:** To establish Langatta as a recognised hub for emerging musical talent, where creativity is nurtured, and young people are equipped to become leaders, creators, and economic contributors within the creative industries.

Target Audience

The primary target audience is youth aged 14–24 in Langatta. This demographic faces specific challenges including:

- High rates of unemployment and underemployment.
- A lack of constructive after-school and extracurricular activities.

- Limited exposure to digital literacy and modern career paths in the creative economy.
- A deep reservoir of cultural and musical expression that lacks a formal outlet.

We will prioritise outreach to at-risk youth, school dropouts, and those demonstrating high musical aptitude but limited resources.

Services Offered

The Langatta Sound Foundry will offer a tiered programme structure:

1. **Open Studio Hours:** Supervised, free-access time for youth to explore equipment, practice, and collaborate.
2. **Workshops & Certificate Courses:** Structured classes in:
 - Music Production (DAWs: Logic Pro, Ableton Live)
 - Audio Engineering & Sound Design
 - Songwriting & Composition
 - Music Business, Marketing, and Copyright
3. **Mentorship Programme:** One-on-one and group mentorship with established local and national producers, artists, and industry executives.
4. **Artist Development:** Support for select individuals and groups to produce professional EPs, singles, and marketing materials for release.
5. **Showcases & Networking Events:** Quarterly events to present work to the community and industry professionals, fostering real-world performance experience.

Location and Facilities

The studio will be located in a central, accessible area of Langatta (e.g., near the Langatta Shopping Centre or along Lang'ata Road). The facility (approximately 140 m²) will be renovated to include:

- **A Professional Recording Booth:** Acoustically treated, with high-quality microphones.
- **A Control Room / Production Lab:** Equipped with 6 high-performance computer workstations with DAWs, MIDI controllers, and studio monitors.
- **A Mixing & Mastering Suite:** A smaller, acoustically critical space for advanced students.
- **A Flexible Classroom/Collaboration Space:** For workshops, lectures, and community gatherings.

- **A Lounge/Resource Area:** A safe space for youth to connect, study, and access resources.

Community Impact

- **Reduces Crime & Antisocial Behaviour:** Provides a constructive, supervised alternative to idle time, which is a known risk factor for youth.
 - **Enhances Employability:** Graduates will gain in-demand technical skills (digital audio workstations, signal flow, project management) applicable in the wider digital economy.
 - **Promotes Cultural Pride:** Elevates local voices and stories, creating a sense of shared identity and accomplishment.
 - **Fosters Entrepreneurship:** Equips youth with the skills to monetise their creativity, creating a new generation of small business owners in the creative sector.
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3. Organisational Information

Organisational Structure

The Langatta Sound Foundry will operate under the fiscal sponsorship of [Name of Established Non-Profit, if applicable] or as its own registered entity under Kenyan law. The leadership structure is as follows:

- **Executive Director (1):** Responsible for overall strategy, fundraising, partnerships, and community relations.
- **Programme Manager (1):** Oversees daily operations, scheduling, volunteer coordination, and student intake.
- **Lead Producer/Instructor (1):** A seasoned music professional responsible for curriculum development, leading advanced production courses, and providing high-level mentorship.
- **Technical Instructor (1):** Focuses on foundational skills, equipment maintenance, and assisting students during open studio hours.
- **Administrative Assistant/Outreach Coordinator (1):** Manages communications, scheduling, and leads recruitment efforts in the community.

Track Record

[If applicable, describe the founding team's experience. Example below]

The founding team brings over 15 years of combined experience in music production, youth education, and community development. Our Executive Director successfully launched a

community arts programme in Kawangware that served 200+ youth. Our Lead Producer has worked with award-winning Kenyan artists and holds a master's degree in Music Technology, with a passion for teaching. We have already piloted a 6-week summer music workshop in Langatta, which served 25 students and resulted in a compilation album that received airplay on local stations such as [Local Radio Station].

4. Market Analysis

Need Assessment

- **Data:** According to a 2025 survey by the Langatta Community Development Office, 72% of youth aged 16–24 report that there are “no engaging activities” available to them after school. Local school budgets for arts and music have been reduced significantly over the past decade, with most schools lacking any digital music equipment.
- **Evidence:** Anecdotal evidence from area chiefs, school principals, and local police points to a recurring request from young people for “a place to make music.” There is a clear, unaddressed demand.

Target Market Size

Langatta has an estimated population of [Number] residents, with approximately 4,500 youth within the 14–24 age bracket. Initial surveys suggest that at least 10% of this demographic (450 individuals) would be interested in music production programming. Our capacity in Year 1 is 150 intensive participants, with a reach of over 500 through workshops and events.

Competitive Landscape

Currently, there are no dedicated, fully equipped music production facilities in Langatta. The closest alternatives are:

- **School Music Programmes:** Focus on traditional choir or instrumental music, not digital production. They lack modern equipment.
- **Commercial Studios in Nairobi CBD:** Are unaffordable for youth and not designed for educational purposes.
- **General Community Centres:** Offer safe spaces but lack specialised equipment and expert mentorship.

Unique Selling Proposition (USP): The LSF is the *only* organisation in Langatta that combines a professional-grade recording studio with a structured, career-focused educational curriculum, specifically designed to serve the needs of local youth at no or low cost.

5. Marketing and Outreach Strategy

Recruitment Plan

1. **School Partnerships:** Direct presentations and workshops at Langatta High School, St. Mary's School, and other local secondary schools.
2. **Community Hubs:** Flyers, presentations, and information sessions at the Langatta Community Centre, local churches, and youth boda boda groups.
3. **Social Media & Local Radio:** A targeted campaign on Instagram, TikTok, and local radio stations (e.g., Ghetto Radio, Hot 96) featuring student-created content to build hype.
4. **Word-of-Mouth & Referral Programme:** Incentivise current participants to bring in friends, building a peer-to-peer recruitment engine.

Partnerships

- **Educational:** Langatta High School, Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development (for accreditation pathways) – for referrals and co-branded workshops.
- **Community:** Langatta Youth Council, Langatta Police Station (through the “Nyumba Kumi” initiative) – to identify and reach at-risk youth.
- **Industry:** [Name of Local Music Store], Music Copyright Society of Kenya (MCSK), [Names of Local Professional Studios/Producers] – for equipment discounts, guest mentorship, and internship pathways.
- **Corporate:** Safaricom (via the Blaze or Ndoto Zetu programmes) – for potential sponsorship and access to youth networks.

6. Operational Plan

Staffing

(As detailed in Section 3)

- 1 Executive Director (FT)
- 1 Programme Manager (FT)
- 1 Lead Producer/Instructor (FT)
- 1 Technical Instructor (FT)
- 1 Administrative/Outreach Coordinator (FT)

- 2–3 Volunteer Interns (from local universities or music colleges)

Programming Schedule (Sample Weekly)

Time	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
3–5 PM	Open Studio (Supervised)	Open Studio	Open Studio	Open Studio	Open Studio	Workshop: Music Business
5–7 PM	Intro to Production (Workshop)	Mentorship (1-on-1 sessions)	Advanced Production (Course)	Songwriting Circle (Workshop)	Open Studio	Artist Development (Select Group)

Risk Management

Risk	Mitigation Strategy
Equipment Theft/Damage	Comprehensive insurance policy (through a reputable Kenyan insurer); strict sign-in/out system; supervised sessions only; security cameras; secure storage for high-value items.
Low Participant Engagement	Flexible scheduling; incorporate youth input into programming; use peer referrals; maintain a strong social media presence to build community.
Staff Turnover	Competitive salaries aligned with local NGO sector; professional development opportunities; detailed documentation of curriculum and operational procedures to ensure continuity.
Financial Sustainability	Diversified funding model (grants, individual donors, fee-for-service workshops, studio rental income). Launch an earned-income strategy in Year 2.

7. Financial Plan

Budget (Year 1) – in Kenyan Shillings (KES)

Category	Item	Cost (KES)
Startup & Capital Costs	Facility Lease & Renovation (first year, deposit, minor build-out, acoustic treatment)	6,000,000
	Recording & Production Equipment (computers, interfaces, mics, monitors, software licenses)	5,200,000
	Furniture & Fixtures	1,300,000
Personnel	Salaries & Benefits (5 FT staff, 1 year)	4,800,000
Programming	Workshop Materials, Marketing, Showcase Events	1,950,000
Operations	Utilities, Insurance, Software Subscriptions, Maintenance	1,950,000
Contingency (10%)	Unforeseen costs	2,100,000
Total		23,300,000

Note: Exchange rate assumption for illustrative conversion – 1 USD ≈ 130 KES. Actual costs based on local market rates.

Funding Request

We are requesting a total of **KES 19,500,000** from this funder. These funds will be allocated as follows:

- **KES 5,200,000** towards Equipment and Software.
- **KES 6,000,000** towards Facility Lease and Renovation.
- **KES 4,800,000** towards initial Personnel costs for the first year, ensuring we have the core team in place to launch successfully.

- **KES 3,500,000** towards Programming, Operations, and a portion of the contingency.

Note: The remaining KES 3,800,000 of the total Year 1 budget will be sought from other grants, individual donors, and corporate sponsors.

Sustainability Plan

The LSF is designed for long-term financial independence beyond the initial seed funding.

- **Year 1:** Reliance on grants and philanthropic support to establish programming.
- **Year 2:** Introduce a sliding-scale fee structure for certificate courses. Initiate **“Studio Rental for Good”** – renting the facility to professional artists at a competitive rate, with the requirement that they offer a free masterclass to students.
- **Year 3:** Develop a robust alumni donor programme. Secure county government support as a recognised community asset. Seek corporate sponsorship for specific programmes (e.g., “The [Safaricom] Beat-Making Challenge”).

8. Appendices (Optional)

- **Appendix A:** Letters of Support from Langatta High School Principal, Langatta Police Station Commander, and [Local Community Leader].
- **Appendix B:** Resumes of Key Personnel.
- **Appendix C:** Detailed Equipment List (with local supplier quotations).
- **Appendix D:** Results of Community Needs Assessment Survey.
- **Appendix E:** Architectural Layout of Proposed Studio Facility.

For more information, please contact:

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